Deforestation in the Western Amazon

1. Introduction

Forest loss in the western Amazon has accelerated since 2010, driven by road building, oil exploration and small scale agriculture along the main rivers. This note summarises the loss recorded in four zones of the basin.

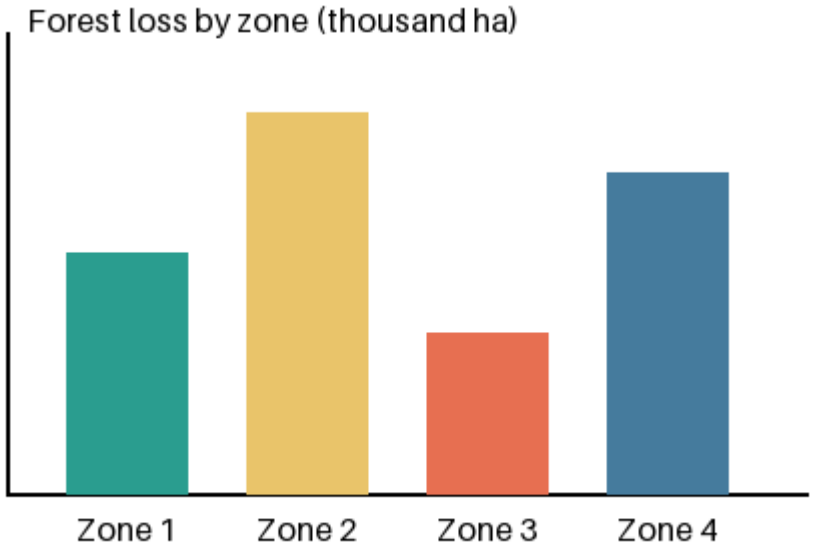

Figure 1. Forest loss by zone.

2. Results

Zone 2 lost the most forest, followed by Zone 4. Zone 3 lost the least because most of its territory lies inside a protected area where clearing is restricted. Loss along roads was three times higher than loss away from them in every zone.

3. Conclusions

Protected areas and road planning explain most of the differences between zones. Monitoring should focus on the corridors where new roads are being opened.